

Lab 9 - Three-Alert SOC Triage

Independent Alert Review, Severity, Verdict, and Escalation Decisions

Attribute	Details
Environment	Windows 11 VM, Wazuh SIEM, Microsoft Defender, PowerShell
Objective	Triage three separate alerts as independent SOC tickets
Exercise type	Controlled analyst decision-making lab

1. Triage Summary

Alert	Severity	Verdict	Escalate?
4625 failed logons	Low	Benign / expected lab activity	No
4104 PowerShell policy query	Low	Benign / administrative activity	No
1116/1117 EICAR detection	Medium	True positive, benign test context	No

2. Alert 1 - Failed Logons

Evidence: Event ID 4625, Logon Type 2, source 127.0.0.1, Wazuh authentication alert. Interpretation: local interactive sign-in failure generated intentionally in the lab. No evidence of remote brute force, credential spraying, or compromise. Decision: Low severity; no escalation.

3. Alert 2 - PowerShell Activity

Evidence: Event ID 4104 recorded a command that exported local security policy, searched for ResetLockoutCount, and removed the temporary file. Observed value: ResetLockoutCount = 10. Interpretation: administrative/security-policy check. No malicious payload, persistence, lateral movement, or credential theft. Decision: Low severity; no escalation.

4. Alert 3 - Defender Detection

Evidence: Defender detected Virus:DOS/EICAR_Test_File and later quarantined it. Interpretation: true positive from the detection engine perspective, but EICAR is a harmless industry-standard test artifact. Decision: Medium severity; no escalation.

5. SOC Analyst Lessons

- Severity is contextual.
- Automated tool mappings are not analyst conclusions.
- PowerShell is dual-use and must be judged by context.
- A true positive detection does not always mean a real incident.
- Separate alerts should remain separate unless evidence links them.

6. Final Assessment

All three alerts were successfully triaged using Windows telemetry, PowerShell Script Block Logging, Defender, and Wazuh. None required escalation because the surrounding context established controlled and authorized activity. The lab demonstrated the difference between alert generation and incident confirmation.